

The Nashville Luxury Home *Seller's Guide*

A private-client roadmap to selling a \$2M+ home in Middle Tennessee.

2026 EDITION

PRESENTED BY

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FOREWORD

A welcome from the seller's side of the table.

Middle Tennessee's luxury tier has matured into one of the most consequential markets in the country — and one of the most nuanced to sell into. Inventory has expanded for the first time in a decade, buyers are better-informed and better-represented than ever, and the gap between homes that command top dollar and those that languish has widened materially.

This guide is the same playbook I run for every \$2M+ seller I represent. It is built around a simple thesis: in this market, the right preparation, the right price, and the right private network — not the loudest marketing — produce the cleanest results.

On the pages that follow you'll find the current state of the luxury seller's market, a submarket-by-submarket valuation playbook, the eight-step process my team runs from listing prep through closing, and the checklists that keep a generational transaction quietly on the rails. When you're ready to begin a private conversation about your home, my team and I are here.

A NOTE FROM JASON

“Selling a luxury home is not a sales exercise — it is a curation exercise. Price it correctly, present it precisely, and place it in front of the right buyer first. The rest takes care of itself.”

\$2.8M

MEDIAN LUXURY SALE 2026 YTD

98.2%

AVG SALE-TO-LIST RATIO • LUXURY TIER

23%

OF LUXURY SALES CLOSE OFF-MARKET

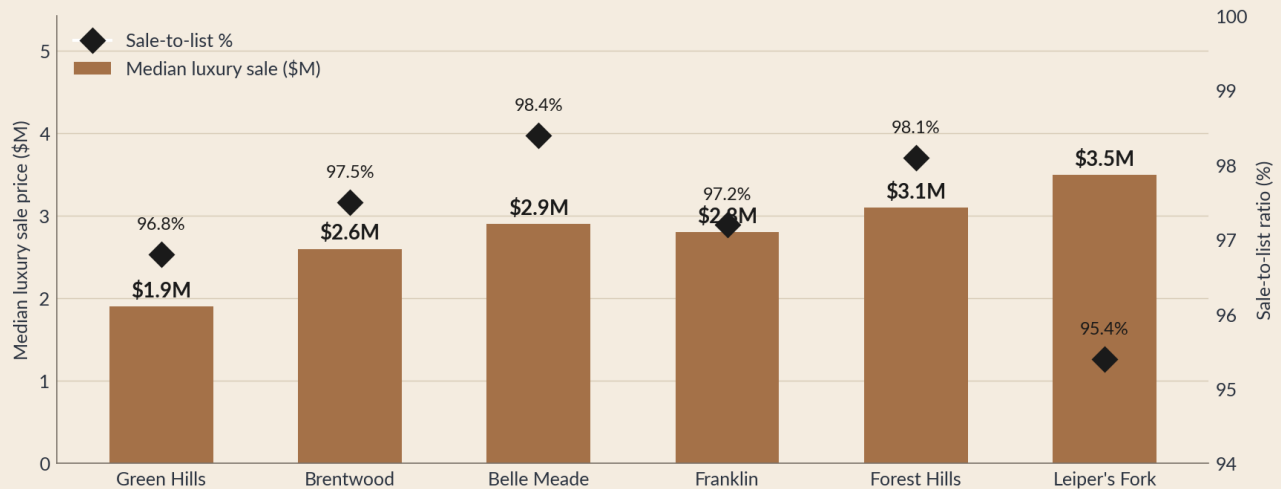
SECTION ONE

The 2026 seller's market, at a glance.

After three years of accelerating appreciation, the \$2M+ tier entered 2026 with its deepest inventory pool since 2014 — a 13% year-over-year expansion. The headline reads ‘the market is cooling,’ but the reality is more interesting: well-prepared homes on premier streets continue to sell quickly, often above list, while mispriced or under-presented homes are sitting on the market three times longer than they did 18 months ago.

Middle Tennessee · luxury tier (\$2M+) · MLS-derived figures, 2026 YTD

Median luxury sale + sale-to-list ratio, by submarket



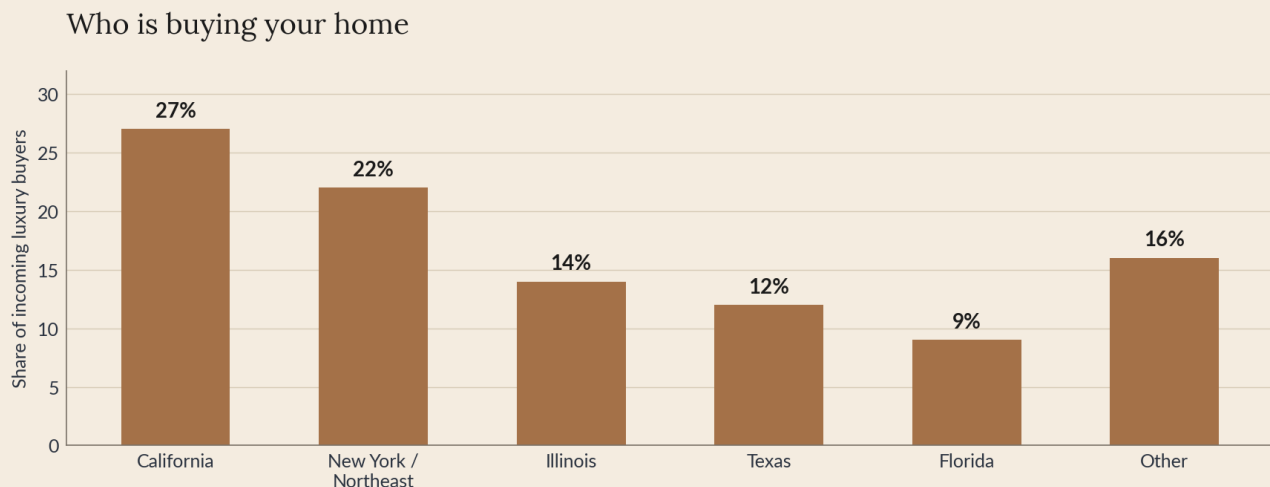
Read the chart: Sale-to-list ratios in the in-town submarkets remain above 97% — sellers are still capturing nearly full asking when they price correctly out of the gate. The exception is Leiper's Fork, where wider price discovery on multi-acre estates produces more meaningful negotiation room and longer cycles.

SECTION ONE (CONT.)

Who is buying your home.

Roughly two-thirds of \$2M+ purchases in Williamson and Davidson counties are now driven by relocating households — not local move-up buyers. Understanding where your buyer is coming from changes how you stage, market, and negotiate.

Estimated origin mix of \$2M+ buyers · 2025–2026



What this means for sellers: Your most likely buyer is a relocating executive, founder, or multi-generational family arriving from a higher-cost metro. They are well-advised, time-constrained, and often making a decision on two to four homes in a 48-hour window. The home they choose is the one that is instantly understandable — photographed beautifully, priced credibly, and represented by an advisor whose name their buyer's agent already knows.

A NOTE FROM JASON

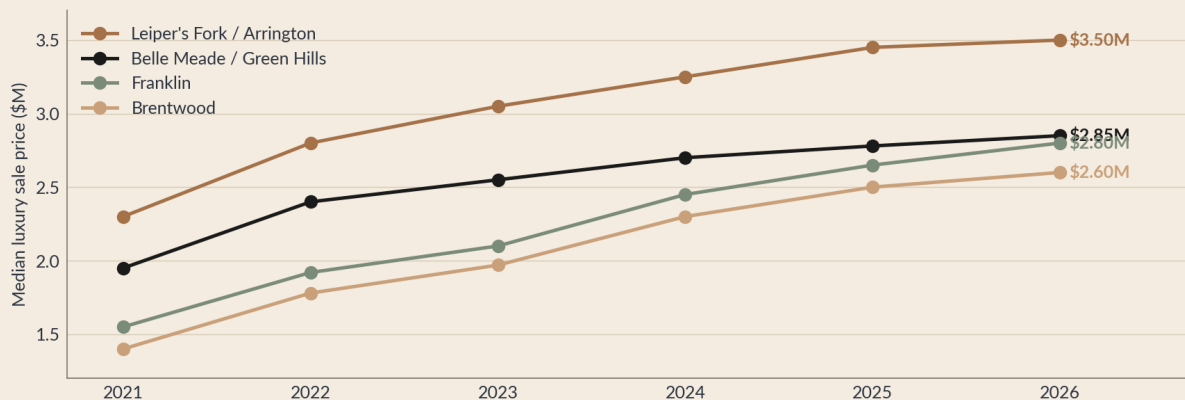
“The relocating buyer almost never sees your home in person before they make an offer. They see it on a phone screen at 30,000 feet. Your photography, your video, and your story are doing the heavy lifting before the front door ever opens.”

SECTION ONE (CONT.)

Where prices have gone — and where they are headed.

Median luxury sale price, year-end · Middle TN submarkets

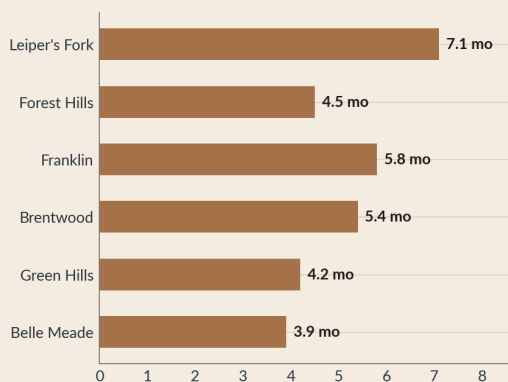
Five-year appreciation in the \$2M+ tier



Since 2021 the \$2M+ tier has appreciated 35–80% across the four primary submarkets. That kind of growth is no longer the base case. For 2026 we are forecasting a steadier 3–5% — healthy, sustainable appreciation that rewards sellers who price into the current market rather than chase last year's comps.

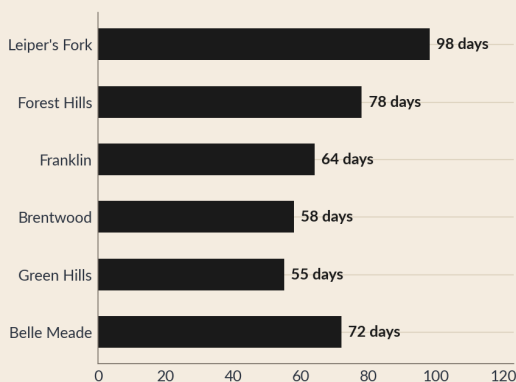
Months of supply · luxury tier

Spring 2026 · \$2M+ inventory ÷ trailing-12 luxury sales



Average days on market · luxury tier

Spring 2026 · \$2M+ listings only



What this means for sellers: A balanced market — roughly 5–6 months of luxury inventory — gives well-positioned sellers leverage without the panic-buying dynamic of 2021–2022. The homes that win are the ones launched correctly the first time. There is no longer a forgiving market to bail out a soft launch.

SECTION TWO

What today's buyer expects from your home.

Buyer expectations in the \$2M+ band have hardened materially over the past 36 months. The features below are no longer differentiators — they are the price of admission. Homes that meet them sell with leverage; homes that don't end up negotiating against the cost of bringing them up to standard.

- Move-in-ready presentation — paint, lighting, hardware, and landscape freshened; no visible deferred maintenance.
- Modern infrastructure — fiber internet, EV charging, smart-home integration (Lutron / Control4 / Crestron), updated mechanicals.
- An outdoor program — saltwater pool, covered loggia, outdoor kitchen, fire feature, sport court, or a defining garden.
- Designer-grade kitchen & primary suite — these two rooms decide most luxury showings; underdone finishes here cost six figures.
- Wellness & storage spaces — a true mudroom, a private office, a gym or sauna, a wine room, oversized garages.
- Documented provenance — architect of record, builder, key vendors, warranties, and a maintenance log buyers can underwrite against.
- Privacy & security — gated entries, perimeter fencing, monitored cameras, and mature landscape screening.
- Tasteful, neutral staging — personal collections quietly edited; the home reads as a buyer's future, not the seller's past.

A NOTE FROM JASON

“A \$4M buyer will not write an offer because your home is ‘nice.’ They will write the offer because they cannot find anything wrong with it. Our job is to remove every reason for them to say no — before they ever walk in.”

SECTION THREE

Selling, submarket by submarket.

Each Middle Tennessee submarket has its own buyer pool, price discipline, and resale rhythm. Below is the version of this story I share with my listing clients.

WILLIAMSON COUNTY • 30 MIN SOUTH OF DOWNTOWN

Franklin

Williamson County's anchor and one of the most liquid luxury submarkets in the Southeast. Top-rated schools, master-planned communities, and a celebrated Main Street keep both inventory and demand deep.

\$2.8M

MEDIAN LUXURY

97.2%

SALE-TO-LIST

64 days

AVG DOM • LUXURY

5.8 mo

MONTHS OF SUPPLY

WHAT SELLERS NEED TO KNOW

- Pre-list off-market for 10–14 days via Compass Private Exclusives — strongest buyers first.
- Price tightly to fresh 90-day comps; this buyer pool is comp-disciplined.
- Westhaven, LaurelBrooke, Berry Farms reward turnkey condition; no open punch lists.
- Downtown historic homes sell on character — invest in lighting and editorial photography.

WILLIAMSON COUNTY • 20 MIN SOUTH OF DOWNTOWN

Brentwood

Family-focused, country-club anchored, and home to Middle Tennessee's most prestigious private-school cluster. Roughly 27% of Brentwood closings are now in the \$2M+ tier.

\$2.6M

MEDIAN LUXURY

97.5%

SALE-TO-LIST

58 days

AVG DOM • LUXURY

5.4 mo

MONTHS OF SUPPLY

WHAT SELLERS NEED TO KNOW

- Governors Club listings should align with spring club season for peak demand.
- Annandale & Hampton Reserve trade on rarity; expect quiet pre-market outreach.
- Old Hickory Blvd. corridor rewards mature landscape and tasteful updates.
- Brentwood schools are a primary driver — lead with the school zone in marketing.

SECTION THREE (CONT.)

In-town: where listings still move fastest.

DAVIDSON COUNTY • 10 MIN FROM DOWNTOWN

Belle Meade

Nashville's most established old-money address — a 3.1 sq mile incorporated city with its own police force, top public schools, and the historic Belle Meade Country Club. Structurally low inventory means well-prepared homes continue to trade quickly and frequently above list.

\$2.9M

MEDIAN LUXURY

98.4%

SALE-TO-LIST

72 days

AVG DOM • LUXURY

3.9 mo

MONTHS OF SUPPLY

WHAT SELLERS NEED TO KNOW

- Privacy sells — list via private exclusive to a curated buyer list before any sign goes in the yard.
- Historic homes command premiums when restored with provenance documentation; modern updates lose value if they erase character.
- The Highlands & Belle Meade Links appeal to downsizers — market to a different buyer profile than the estate streets.
- Pricing above \$4M requires extensive comparables modeling; the band is thin and pricing errors are punished.

DAVIDSON COUNTY • 8 MIN FROM DOWNTOWN

Green Hills / Hillsboro / Sylvan Park

The most urban of the luxury submarkets: dense, walkable retail, top public and private schools, and a mix of mid-century ranches, new modern builds, and luxury condominium product. The luxury buyer pool here skews younger and more design-driven than the estate submarkets.

\$1.9M

MEDIAN LUXURY

96.8%

SALE-TO-LIST

55 days

AVG DOM • LUXURY

4.2 mo

MONTHS OF SUPPLY

WHAT SELLERS NEED TO KNOW

- Modern, design-forward homes outperform here — bold but tasteful interior choices read as confidence, not risk.
- Hillsboro/Sylvan Park walkability is a measurable price premium; lead with it in marketing.
- The Reserve & condo product require a separate marketing motion — lock-and-leave buyers respond to lifestyle, not square footage.
- Tear-down lots trade on land value; market to builders directly in parallel with end-user marketing.

SECTION THREE (CONT.)

Forest Hills, Oak Hill & the estate corridor.

DAVIDSON COUNTY • 15 MIN FROM DOWNTOWN

Forest Hills & Oak Hill

Davidson County's two incorporated luxury cities: large, wooded lots, exceptional privacy, and a steady rebuild market. Forest Hills and Oak Hill consistently produce the highest median sale prices in Davidson County outside of Belle Meade.

\$3.1M

MEDIAN LUXURY

98.1%

SALE-TO-LIST

78 days

AVG DOM • LUXURY

4.5 mo

MONTHS OF SUPPLY

WHAT SELLERS NEED TO KNOW

- Lot value drives pricing — a tired house on an acre may outperform a renovated house on a smaller lot.
- Builders are active buyers; consider parallel marketing to the top 10 area builders before public launch.
- Mature landscape is a major asset — invest in arborist cleanup and lighting before photography.
- The buyer pool is small but discerning; private-exclusive marketing almost always outperforms a public splash.

WILLIAMSON COUNTY • 35-45 MIN FROM DOWNTOWN

Leiper's Fork & Arrington

For sellers of 5 to 100+ acre estates — celebrity-grade compounds, equestrian properties, working farms, and the new Arbors at Leiper's Fork. Limited buyer pool, longer cycles, and the strongest case in the region for running a fully private sale process.

\$3.5M

MEDIAN LUXURY

95.4%

SALE-TO-LIST

98 days

AVG DOM • LUXURY

7.1 mo

MONTHS OF SUPPLY

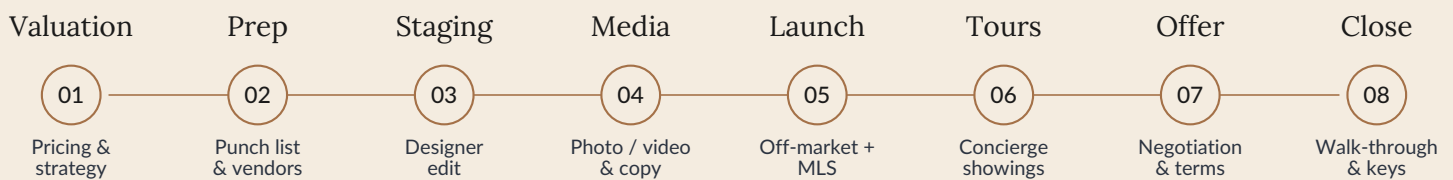
A NOTE FROM JASON

“Roughly one in three of my Leiper's Fork and estate transactions never touches the MLS. The right buyer for a \$6M compound is on a list of two dozen people, not a Zillow feed. Marketing a generational estate publicly often costs more than it earns.”

SECTION FOUR

The eight-step luxury selling process.

Every Nashville Luxury List listing runs on the same disciplined framework. We move with intention, never urgency — and we never let a single detail fall through the cracks.



01 • VALUATION

An on-site walk and a deep comp analysis: 24-month sold comps, current actives, and the off-market deals only an active luxury advisor knows. We arrive at a data-backed list price and a defensible range for negotiation.

02 • PRE-LISTING PREP

Punch list, inspector pre-walk, vendor coordination — paint, lighting, hardware, landscape, mechanical tune-ups. The goal: zero buyer concerns, zero inspection surprises.

03 • STAGING & STYLING

Designer-led editing, furniture refresh where needed, art placement, and a quiet personal-effects edit. The home reads as the buyer's future.

04 • MEDIA PRODUCTION

Editorial photography, cinematic video tour, drone, twilight stills, floor-plan rendering, written narrative — all in service of the relocating buyer making a decision on a screen.

05 • LAUNCH STRATEGY

Compass Private Exclusive window first, then Coming Soon, then full MLS — a three-stage launch that captures every meaningful buyer pool without burning first impressions.

06 • TOURS & SHOWINGS

Concierge-managed, by-appointment showings. Broker preview events for high-volume agents. Real-time feedback synthesized weekly.

07 • OFFER & NEGOTIATION

Multiple-offer architecture when warranted, single-offer leverage when not. We negotiate on terms, contingencies, and timeline — not just price.

08 • DUE DILIGENCE & CLOSE

Inspection response strategy, appraisal coordination, title, wire, walk-through, and a curated post-close handoff. Discretion through closing day.

SECTION FIVE

Preparing your home to command top dollar.

Preparation is the highest-ROI work in any luxury sale. A disciplined six-week prep cycle routinely produces \$100K–\$500K of incremental price — and shortens days on market by 30–60%. The checklists below are what my team runs for every listing before a single photograph is taken.

PUNCH LIST & CONDITION

- Pre-inspection by a licensed inspector — repair, do not negotiate later.
- Touch-up paint throughout; full repaint of high-traffic interior rooms.
- Hardware, lighting, and switch-plate refresh; replace anything tired.
- Roof, gutters, HVAC, water heater, irrigation — service and document.

STAGING & INTERIOR EDIT

- Designer-led furniture edit; supplement with rented pieces where needed.
- Personal collections (family photos, religious items, trophies) quietly stored.
- Art swapped for neutral, transitional pieces if existing reads too personal.
- Closets and pantries reduced to 60% capacity — buyers read empty space as room.

EXTERIOR & LANDSCAPE

- Full arborist visit: dead-wooding, canopy lift, mulch refresh.
- Pressure-wash driveway, walkways, patios; reseal any pool decking.
- Front-door refresh: new mat, hardware polish, fresh paint if needed.
- Garage edit — buyers open every door, including yours.

MEDIA-READY SET-UP

- Bulbs replaced to consistent 3000K color temp across the home.
- Pool, fountains, and any water features on for photography day.
- All cars off the property; landscaping and trash bins out of sight.
- Pets boarded for photo day and through the listing's first 14 days.

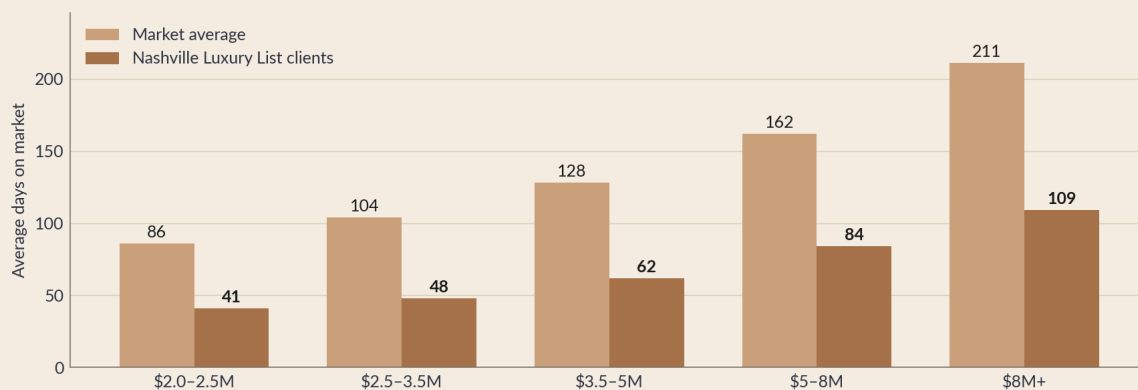
SECTION SIX

Pricing strategy & timing.

In a balanced market, the price you set in week one is the most important decision of the entire sale. The data is unambiguous: homes priced correctly out of the gate sell in roughly half the time and at sale-to-list ratios two to three points higher than homes that arrive overpriced and chase the market downward.

Middle Tennessee · \$2M+ tier · 2024–2026 closed sales

Average days on market by price band



Read the chart: The market-average days on market grows non-linearly with price. Above \$5M, a conventionally listed home averages five to seven months on market. The same home, prepared and priced strategically, transacts in 12 weeks — often without a public launch at all.

Timing windows that matter: Mid-February through early June captures roughly 55% of annual \$2M+ closings. A secondary window opens September through early November. Holiday-season listings (mid-November through January) work for two specific sellers: those with a credible deadline (relocation, divorce, estate), and those willing to trade fewer showings for a more serious buyer pool with less competition.

SECTION SEVEN

The marketing strategy that sells luxury.

A luxury home does not need more marketing — it needs the right marketing, delivered to the right buyer in the right order. Below is the launch sequence we run for every Nashville Luxury List listing.

- Stage 1 — Private Exclusive (Day 1–14). Listed on the Compass Private Exclusives network and surfaced to my personal buyer list. Captures the off-market 23% of luxury transactions before the public ever sees the home.
- Stage 2 — Coming Soon (Day 14–21). A pre-launch teaser to the broader agent and buyer community. Builds anticipation and a list of qualified showing requests ready to act on launch day.
- Stage 3 — Full MLS launch. Activated with cinematic video, editorial photography, drone, twilight, written narrative, floor plans, and a dedicated single-property website. Syndicated to Compass.com, NYTimes.com, WSJ.com, MansionGlobal, Robb Report, and ~900 luxury-aligned digital destinations.
- National & international reach. Targeted distribution into the feeder metros — LA, NYC, Bay Area, Chicago, Miami — where 70% of incoming Middle TN buyers live today.
- Broker outreach & events. Curated broker preview, private tours with the top 25 luxury teams in Middle TN, and direct outreach to the out-of-state agents who represent relocating buyers.
- Editorial & print. Where appropriate: features in Nashville Lifestyles, Athlon, Garden & Gun, and full-page placements in WSJ Mansion for \$5M+ estates.
- Social, digital & PR. Geotargeted Meta and YouTube campaigns to lookalike audiences of recent Middle TN luxury buyers; coordinated press outreach for landmark listings.

A NOTE FROM JASON

“Most luxury marketing budgets are spent on the wrong audience. The win isn't impressions — it's the right relocating buyer seeing your home, on the right device, the moment they begin their search.”

SECTION EIGHT

Negotiation, diligence & closing day.

An offer is the start of the negotiation, not the end. The categories below are where most luxury transactions actually win or lose value — and where experienced representation pays for itself many times over.

EVALUATING OFFERS BEYOND PRICE

- Buyer financial strength: jumbo vs. portfolio vs. private bank vs. cash.
- Contingency structure: appraisal, financing, inspection, sale-of-home.
- Earnest money size, escrow timing, due-diligence period length.
- Closing date flexibility and any required seller lease-back.

INSPECTION & DILIGENCE RESPONSE

- Pre-list inspection on file eliminates 80% of post-offer surprises.
- Repair-vs.-credit strategy aligned to your tax position and timeline.
- Specialty inspectors handled directly by our team (pool, septic, geothermal, smart-home).
- Appraisal management: comp packet pre-delivered to the appraiser on arrival.

CONTRACT, TITLE & CLOSING

- TN-specific contract review with your attorney; coordinated entity titling.
- Title clearance, survey verification, easement and HOA-document delivery.
- Wire-fraud protection protocol with all parties; secure closing portals.
- Final walk-through, key handoff, and curated post-close transition support.

YOUR ADVISOR

Meet Jason Kloess.



Jason Kloess is a luxury real-estate advisor with Compass RE in Nashville and the founder of Nashville Luxury List — Middle Tennessee's go-to private resource for \$2M+ home sellers, buyers, and relocating families.

He represents listing clients across Davidson and Williamson counties, with particular depth in Franklin, Brentwood, Belle Meade, Green Hills, Forest Hills, and Leiper's Fork. His listing practice is built on three principles: experience earned through hundreds of high-end transactions; discretion that protects the privacy his sellers require; and results measured in shorter days on market, higher sale-to-list ratios, and cleaner closings.

Jason works hand-in-hand with a vetted network of attorneys, lenders, designers, stagers, photographers, and concierge providers — putting an entire white-glove team behind every listing.

WHAT SELLERS GET

- A pricing strategy and market analysis grounded in current MLS + off-market data
- Editorial-grade media: photography, cinematic video, drone, and copy
- Compass national network & Private Exclusive marketing reach
- Vetted stager, designer, photographer, and trade-vendor network
- Discreet, by-appointment showings managed by my concierge team
- Sale-to-list optimization and post-close transition support

LET'S BEGIN

Experience. Discretion. Results.

Whether you are selling, upgrading, or transitioning a generational estate, every conversation begins privately — on your timeline, without obligation.

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